Lesson Plan Day 1: Introduce Students to YAWP!

In this lesson, students will be introduced to the YAWP! assignment and create their YAWP! accounts.

STUDENTS WILL…

- Understand the purpose and philosophy of the YAWP! assignment
- Read a sample essay
- Create their YAWP! accounts and join your class

TEACHER WILL…

- Explain YAWP!
- Facilitate brief discussion on sample essay
- Lead students through joining your class on YAWP!

MATERIALS NEEDED

Slide deck · Sample essay handout (“Bored in the USA”), one per student · Student laptops/chromebooks and access to yawp.school · Before class: your class set up in YAWP!, with the Thesis-Driven Essay assigned

Instructions

1. Open with the game **“2 Truths and a Lie.”** This is designed to simply engage students in a fun way at the top of the program.

   SLIDES 2–5

   a. The two reveal slides are Brian’s own. Make your own version, with two photos of yourself and your own two truths and a lie, using his as the model. Or delete them.

   SLIDES 3–4

2. **Define YAWP!**

   a. Using Walt Whitman’s quote, define the term “yawp” for the students.

   SLIDES 6–7

   b. Using the slides, discuss why we write. This creates shared context and understanding of “What’s the point of this?”

   SLIDE 8

3. **Read Sample Essay.** Hand out the sample essay (“Bored in the USA,” the Sample essay handout in the Modules). Don’t overanalyze or get in the weeds here. Let students connect to it and then help them find the thesis statement.

   SLIDES 9–10

a. Show the Critical Essay Form and what the class is here to do: write a thoughtful, original, critical essay.

SLIDES 11–12

4. **Onboard students to yawp.school.** The website is simply “yawp.school”: there is no “www” or “.com.”

a. Open your class in YAWP! and go to its **Students** tab. Share the **join link**, or put its QR code up on the board. (The class code shown there is for your reference; it isn’t enough to join.)

SLIDE 13

b. Students open the link on their device, choose a display name, a handle and a password, and click **Join class.** No email needed. The Student Sign-up handout walks them through it.

SLIDE 14

c. Keep a note of handles and passwords, or give the class a pattern to follow, to avoid the inevitable forgotten passwords. You can reset a student’s password from the Students tab.

d. Once they’re in, have students open the class from their dashboard and start the Thesis-Driven Essay, which creates their document. Next class they open the same document (not a new one) and begin pre-writing.

SLIDE 15

Adapted from Brian Connell’s lesson plan for the YAWP! Writing Program, with slide numbers for the new deck. Step 4 is updated for today’s join flow; the old plan’s “Welcome to YAWP!” course and Welcome Exercise are retired.